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P.C. Alexander, R.N. Kao and B. Raman

IN THIS chapter, I will examine, very briefly, the roles played in Op-2 by P.C. Alexander, principal secretary to the PM, R.N. Kao, senior advisor, and B. Raman, a senior R&AW officer, during the period from early 1981 to November 1984. Their respective working styles were also, to a large extent, symptomatic of the three different ways of functioning of government servants in the country.

The first category comprised those who would do anything to please their bosses, in the hope that their services would be suitably rewarded at an appropriate time. While nursing such ambitions they acted as front persons, created deniability, did their best to cover their tracks, and justified controversial actions taken by or on behalf of their bosses, under all circumstances.

The second category rendered appropriate advice on all occasions, based on their experience, expertise and knowledge, without expecting anything in return. They also came up with alternative plans and solutions to problems as and when they thought things were not moving in the right direction. But once a decision was taken by their bosses, they abided by it till the end.

To the third category belonged those hardworking and conscientious officers who had no personal axe to grind and carried out the tasks assigned to them in right earnest as part of their normal duties. While performing their duties, they somehow convinced